

Social Engineering Case Lab



BIG IDEA Most attacks on people persuade a person and skip breaking technology. Manipulation follows recognizable patterns, and anyone can be targeted by a well-made script. Noticing one is a skill, with no talent required. Defense only.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: R3 HOOKS card per student and Case Cards C1 to C8 (each group of 3 to 4 gets two), Workbook W3 Case Lab Sheet, HOOKS written vertically on the board.

- ☐ Print and cut Case Cards C1 to C8; eight groups cover all eight.
- ☐ Write HOOKS on the board: Hurry, Official, Offer or outrage, Keep it quiet, Strange method.
- ☐ Case C3 is the money-mule pattern: teach recognition and the legal point only.

1 HOOK 2 MIN *60-second script* Say: “A magician does not need to hack your eyes. They steer your attention. Social engineering is the same trick: instead of breaking a lock, the attacker persuades someone to open it. It works on smart people, because it is designed for smart people who are busy, tired, or caring. A good script triggers fear, hope, loyalty, urgency. So we will not ask who is dumb enough to fall for this. Nobody is. We will ask what the pattern is, and what one move breaks it. Today you are the analysts. Every case is made up, and none teaches how to do this. They teach how to see it.”

FUN BOOST 1 a.m. Test. Each group presents its Check in 30 seconds and the class rates it 1 to 5: could I really do this tired at 1 a.m.? Low scores revise to a realistic Check.

LEVEL-UP Family Check Agreement. Choose a family code word and callback rule, or keep a one-week Hook Diary: note hooks you see without clicking or screenshotting, and bring a description.

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN *Case Lab*

- 1 (1 min) Orient.** For each case, answer on the sheet: (1) Which HOOKS are present? (2) What is the **ask**? (3) What is the **Check**, a second-channel way to confirm? (4) If someone already did it, what are the first two moves?
- 2 (4 min) Analyze.** Steer the Check toward actions the student controls: call the number on the back of the card, open the app yourself, use a callback or family code word, ask a trusted adult. Fix It moves: **Lock** (change the password from a safe device, turn on 2-step), **Tell** a trusted adult, **Report** (the platform, your bank, reportfraud.ftc.gov). Telling is the fastest fix, and shame slows people down.
- 3 (3 min) Share-out.** Two or three groups: “Our case was _____. The HOOKS were _____. Our Check was _____.” Tally the hooks. What do all the Checks have in common? (They leave the attacker’s channel for one you chose.)

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** “Why does ‘Keep it quiet’ make every other hook stronger?”
- 2** “How would you tell a real friend asking for help from a script?”
- 3** “If you did fall for one, what would stop you from telling someone? How can we make that easier?”

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “Every case had a Pause moment: the second you felt hurried, flattered, or scared. Your best move is to Check in a channel you chose, and to Tell someone, especially when told not to. Add to your Defense Plan: ‘My go-to Check is _____.’”

Hand signal: Hackles up? In each case the first sign was a feeling (hand brushed up the neck, optional). Post it: “Hurry is the tell.”

EXIT TICKET “Pick one hook and write the one sentence you would say to yourself or a friend to break it.” (Example: “A real company will not mind if I call them back.”)

DIFFERENTIATE Give a pre-marked case (HOOKS highlighted) and the frame “A real _____ would _____, so I will _____.”

FAMILY CARD Ask: “Which hook have you seen?” Agree on a family Check: if anyone asks for money or a code in a hurry, hang up and call back on a known number. Keep a family code word off social media.

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing.”
- “This is not your fault, and you are not in trouble.”
- “I can’t keep this secret. I need to bring in people who can help, and I will tell you who.”
- **Do not say:** “How could you fall for that?”
- “I won’t tell anyone.”
- “You should have told someone sooner.”

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away. Follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.